

# M■ORI

## A COMPLETE DEEP DIVE

Aotearoa New Zealand — Whakapapa, the Five Atua, Te Reo M■ori, the Haka,  
Wharenui, Tangihanga, and the Treaty of Waitangi

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Ko au te awa. Ko te awa ko au.  
I am the river. The river is me.

The Whanganui River is a legal person in New Zealand law.  
Not a metaphor. Not a principle.  
A legal person with rights and standing in court.  
The Whanganui iwi said this for 700 years  
before Parliament agreed.

The haka is not a dance.  
Te reo is not just a language.  
The marae is not just a meeting ground.  
Whakapapa is not just genealogy.  
These are the specific technologies  
through which a people maintain  
their sacred relationship with existence.  
Grand Rising.

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## A Note on Sacred Knowledge and Māori Sovereignty

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The Māori people maintain specific control over their most restricted tapu (sacred) knowledge — including specific whakapapa lines held by specific families, the most protected ceremonial prayers held by specific tohunga, and sacred knowledge that belongs to specific iwi and is not for public distribution. This document presents what Māori scholars, cultural organizations, the New Zealand government's partnership documents, and the Māori people's own publicly shared cultural resources have made available. Māori sovereignty over their sacred knowledge, their culture, their language, and their land — Aotearoa — is honored without qualification.

## Introduction

# Aotearoa and the Māori: Who They Are

The Māori — the indigenous Polynesian people of Aotearoa New Zealand — are one of the most remarkable examples in the world of an indigenous culture that faced colonial suppression, refused to disappear, and produced instead one of the most sustained and most successful indigenous cultural renaissances in modern history. They are approximately 900,000 people — roughly 17% of New Zealand's population — who have in the past forty years reclaimed their language from near-extinction, reasserted their political sovereignty through the Treaty of Waitangi framework, produced internationally recognized literature, film, music, and art, and achieved legal recognition of their rivers and mountains as persons with rights in their own right.

The Māori sacred world is organized around a small number of core concepts that interpenetrate everything: whakapapa (genealogy as the sacred framework connecting all existence), mana (the sacred force that flows through right relationship and right action), tapu (sacred restriction, the protected status of the divine), and the living presence of the atua (sacred beings) in every dimension of the natural world. None of these concepts is merely religious in the Western sense — they are simultaneously theological, ecological, political, and practical, governing everything from how a person introduces themselves to how water rights are determined in court.

### MāORI — KEY CONTEXT FOR THE HALIGRICITY LIBRARY

THE SCALE: Approximately 900,000 Māori in New Zealand (2023 census). An additional 170,000+ Māori diaspora in Australia and globally. The largest indigenous Pacific population. THE TRIBAL STRUCTURE: Iwi (tribe) → Hapū (subtribe/clan) → Whānau (extended family). Identity at every level flows through whakapapa. A Māori person introduces themselves by naming their mountain, their river, their waka (ancestral canoe), their iwi, their hapū, their ancestors — before naming themselves. The individual is the last item in the introduction. The context comes first. THE LEGAL CONTEXT: New Zealand's foundational document is the Treaty of Waitangi (1840) — a treaty between the British Crown and Māori chiefs that is understood by both parties very differently. Its interpretation is the primary ongoing political and legal dynamic in New Zealand. The Waitangi Tribunal (established 1975) investigates Crown violations of Treaty principles. THE HALIGRIC RELEVANCE: The Māori tradition is one of the most complete available models of a living sacred worldview in which the divine is not separate from the natural world, the human community, or the political structure — but is the interior sacred dimension of all of them simultaneously. The Whanganui River as legal person is the Haligric understanding of the sacred in nature expressed in the specific language of Western law.

## MŌRI COSMOLOGY

### Te Kore, Te Pū, Te Ao — The Three States of Existence

The MŌri cosmological narrative describes the progression from absolute void through darkness to the present world — each stage not a chronological sequence in the Western sense but a dimensional structure that is simultaneously the history of existence and the current organization of reality.

#### THE THREE STATES — COMPLETE

**TE KORE (THE VOID / NOTHINGNESS):** The first and most profound state — but Te Kore is not simple emptiness. It is not the absence of things but the presence of pure potential before any differentiation has occurred. The MŌri tradition names multiple stages of Te Kore — Te Kore-tū-whiwhia (the void of not possessing), Te Kore-i-ai (the void of not being), Te Kore-tū-mārama (the void without light) — each naming a different quality of the absolute before existence. Te Kore is philosophically parallel to the Taoist concept of Wu (non-being as the ground of all being) and to the Dzogchen concept of the ground of primordial purity — the void that contains everything because it is not yet contracted into anything. **TE PŪ (THE DARKNESS / THE NIGHT):** From Te Kore, Te Pū emerged — the great darkness, the night of potential becoming, the pre-dawn of existence. Like Te Kore, Te Pū is understood in multiple stages of deepening darkness before the first light. Te Pū is the state of gestation — the darkness of the womb before birth, the darkness before the dawn. It is not evil or threatening; it is the specific necessary preceding state of all emergence. The sacred significance of night, of winter, of the dark moon, of silence before the dawn — all are understood through the lens of Te Pū as the specific condition from which all manifestation emerges. **TE AO (THE WORLD OF LIGHT / THE PRESENT WORLD):** From Te Pū, Te Ao Mārama (the world of clear light) emerged — the present, manifest world of light, of distinction, of form, of relationship. The human world. The world of the atua and of people. The world that is sustained by the specific sacred practices, the specific ceremonies, and the specific maintenance of right relationship that MŌri sacred life is organized around.

## Ranginui and Papatūnuku

### The Sacred Parents and the Great Separation

The most foundational narrative in Māori cosmology is the story of Ranginui (Sky Father) and Papatūnuku (Earth Mother) — the divine parents whose embrace was so complete that their children lived in darkness between them, and whose eventual separation created the space for all life.

#### RANGINUI AND PAPATŪNUKU — THE COMPLETE NARRATIVE

**THE PRIMAL EMBRACE:** Ranginui (the sky) and Papatūnuku (the earth) were locked in continuous, complete embrace — Ranginui above, Papatūnuku below, their bodies pressed together with no space between them. Their children — Tāne, Tangaroa, Tū, Rongo, Haumia, and others — grew in the cramped darkness between their parents' bodies, unable to stand, unable to see, unable to develop into what they were meant to be. **THE DEBATE:** The children debated among themselves what to do. Most agreed they should separate their parents — but how? Tāne proposed pushing them apart (he would push Ranginui upward while his feet remained planted on Papatūnuku). Others proposed different approaches. Tū advocated killing them — the most decisive and most violent position (establishing his character as the atua of war and decisive human action). **THE SEPARATION:** Tāne performed the separation — lying on his back with his feet pressed against Ranginui and his shoulders braced against Papatūnuku, he pushed with all his strength. Slowly, Ranginui was forced upward. The space between the divine parents widened. Light entered the world for the first time. The children stood and stretched for the first time. Life as it currently exists became possible. **THE GRIEF:** Ranginui wept — his tears became rain, falling from the sky to Papatūnuku below. Papatūnuku sighed — her breath became the mist that rises from the earth toward the sky. The ongoing weather is understood as the expression of the sacred parents' continuing grief at their separation — the rain as Ranginui's tears, the mist as Papatūnuku's longing. At the end of all things, they will be reunited. **THE HALIGRIC PARALLEL:** The separation of the sacred parents to create space for life is the Māori expression of the same cosmological understanding found in the Mesopotamian Marduk splitting Tiamat, the Hindu Shiva separating from Shakti, and the Taoist division of the primordial Tao into yin and yang. The world is not created from nothing — it is created from the differentiation of what was originally unified, and the longing for reunion is built into the structure of existence.

# TĀNE MAHUTA

## God of Forests, Birds, Humans, and the Three Baskets of Sacred Knowledge

Tāne (Tāne Mahuta — Tāne, Lord of the Forest) is the atua most intimately connected to human beings — the one who separated the sacred parents, who filled the world with trees and birds, who created the first human being from the earth, and who climbed to the highest heaven to obtain the sacred knowledge that made human civilization possible.

| TĀNE — THE COMPLETE SACRED PORTRAIT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
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| <p>THE FORESTS: Tāne is the lord of the forests — every tree, every bird, every living being of the land is under his protection and governance. The kauri tree (<i>Agathis australis</i>), which can live for 2,000 years and reach 50 meters in height, is Tāne's most sacred material manifestation on earth. Ancient kauri groves are among the most sacred natural sites in Aotearoa. Cutting a kauri without proper ceremony and permission was understood as an offense against Tāne directly.</p> <p>THE BIRDS: The birds of Aotearoa are Tāne's children — placed in the trees that were themselves Tāne's original attempt to clothe the naked Papatūmuku. The huia (now extinct), the kiwi, the kererū (wood pigeon), the tūī, the pūwakawaka (fantail) — each is a specific sacred being whose behavior carries specific sacred meaning. The fantail following a person through the forest is understood as carrying a message. The morepork (ruru — the native owl) calling at night is an ancestral warning. Tāne's birds are not decorative; they are the living communication network between the human world and the sacred world.</p> <p>THE CREATION OF HINEAHUONE: To create the first human being, Tāne fashioned a figure from the red clay of Kurawaka (the earth at Papatūmuku's body) — shaping her in the form of a woman (because Papatūmuku's body is female). He breathed life into her through her nostrils, mouth, and ears. She sneezed, opened her eyes, and became Hineahuone — the earth-formed woman, the first human being. The name means literally 'she who was formed from clay.'</p> |
| TĀNE AND THE THREE BASKETS OF KNOWLEDGE — COMPLETE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |

The most philosophically significant of Tāne's sacred acts is his ascent to Tikanga (the highest of the twelve heavens) to retrieve the three baskets (kete) of sacred knowledge that Io Matua Kore (the supreme divine, the parentless one) had placed there for humanity.

**THE THREE BASKETS:**

**KETE ARONUI (The Basket of Peace, Love, and Benevolence):** The first basket — containing the knowledge and wisdom that enables peaceful community life, right relationship, and the cultivation of love and compassion between people. This is the basket most associated with the sacred dimension of ordinary life.

**KETE TUATEA (The Basket of Knowledge and Science):** The second basket — containing the specific knowledge of the natural world, of arts and crafts, of the skills that enable human civilization. The knowledge of how to build a waka (canoe), how to read the stars, how to cultivate food.

**KETE TUAURI (The Basket of Ritual and Ceremony):** The third basket — containing the specific sacred knowledge: the prayers, the ceremonies, the sacred protocols, the ritual language that maintains the relationship between the human world and the divine world. This is the most restricted of the three baskets — some of its content is tapu and held by specific tohunga.

**THE SIGNIFICANCE:** The three baskets represent the complete sacred economy of human knowledge — the practical (science and craft), the relational (love and peace), and the sacred (ceremony and ritual). All three are necessary. None is more important than the others. A person with only the practical basket is a technician without wisdom. A person with only the sacred basket is a priest without the capacity to build and grow. Tāne's three baskets model the Haligric Tetralty's insistence on the integration of all dimensions of human capacity.

## TANGAROA, T■, RONGO, and HAUMIA

### The Four Remaining Major Atua

#### TANGAROA — GOD OF THE SEA AND ALL AQUATIC LIFE

Tangaroa is the lord of the ocean — all fish, all sea creatures, all things that live in water are his children and under his governance. The relationship between T■ne and Tangaroa is one of the most important sacred dynamics in M■ori cosmology — they are brothers who exist in creative tension. Fish that hide in the seaweed and rocky shore (where T■ne's influence extends) are understood as taking refuge in T■ne's domain from Tangaroa's authority. Fishing is thus always a negotiation between the two brothers' domains. THE CONTEMPORARY EXPRESSION: The M■ori approach to ocean conservation is not merely environmental — it is a sacred obligation to maintain right relationship with Tangaroa. Commercial overfishing is not just an ecological problem in the M■ori framework; it is a violation of the sacred relationship with a living divine being. The legal battles over New Zealand's fishing rights are, from the M■ori perspective, theological disputes about the appropriate relationship between human beings and the god of the sea.

#### T■ (T■MATAUENGA) — GOD OF PEOPLE AND WAR

T■'s full name — T■matauenga — means 'T■ of the angry face' or 'T■ who faces his enemies.' He is the atua of the human being in their most decisive, most combative, and most willful dimension. In the original debate about what to do with the sacred parents, T■ alone advocated killing them. He was outvoted, but his willingness to consider the most extreme action established his sacred character: the capacity for decisive, absolute action is his specific divine gift to humanity. THE HAKA CONNECTION: The haka is, in its war dimension, intimately connected to T■ — the ceremony concentrates collective human mana into a directed force under T■'s specific patronage. Warriors preparing for battle invoked T■. Contemporary M■ori who engage in political confrontation, in legal battles, in the hard work of cultural reclamation — these are all expressions of T■'s specific sacred energy in the contemporary world.

#### RONGO — GOD OF PEACE AND ALL CULTIVATED PLANTS

Rongo (Rongo-mā-Tāne) is the atua of peace, of kumara (sweet potato — the most sacred food plant), and of all cultivated food plants. He represents the human capacity for patience, for cultivation, for the long work of growing something from a seed. His sacred role is the specific complement to Tā's warrior energy — where Tā acts decisively in crisis, Rongo cultivates steadily across seasons. THE KUMARA: The kumara was not native to Aotearoa — it was brought from the tropical Pacific by the Māori ancestors in the waka migrations, maintained across enormous distances in the canoes, and established in the cooler climate of Aotearoa through specific sacred agricultural knowledge. Every step of the kumara's cultivation cycle — the preparation of the ground, the planting, the growing, the harvest, the storage — required specific ceremonies addressed to Rongo. The kumara was sacred long before it arrived in Aotearoa, and Rongo's patronage over it reflects the specific sacred work of bringing life across an ocean and establishing it in a new land.

#### **HAUMIA-TIKETIKE — GOD OF WILD AND UNCULTIVATED FOOD**

Haumia is the atua of everything that grows wild and uncultivated — the fern root (aruhe), the berries, the wild plants gathered from the forest and the field without human cultivation. Where Rongo governs what human beings plant and tend, Haumia governs what the earth provides spontaneously. Together, Rongo and Haumia represent the complete food relationship between the human community and Papatūmānuku — both the cultivated and the given, both the planted and the found.

## MŪI

### The Trickster Demigod — Complete Sacred Stories

MŪi is the most beloved and most widely known figure in Polynesian sacred tradition — a demigod and trickster who appears across all of Polynesia in various forms but who takes his most complete and most elaborated form in the Māori tradition of Aotearoa.

#### MŪI — THE COMPLETE SACRED NARRATIVE

**THE MIRACULOUS BIRTH:** MŪi was the youngest of several brothers — born prematurely and believed dead. His mother (Taranga) wrapped him in a topknot of her hair (in some versions) and cast him into the sea. He was found and raised by his ancestor Tama-nui-ki-te-rangi. He rejoined his family only later, establishing himself as the unexpected, underestimated youngest brother whose tricks and whose magical power would transform the world.

**MŪI FISHES UP THE NORTH ISLAND:** Using a hook made from the jawbone of his sacred grandmother (Murirangawhenua) and his own blood as bait, MŪi fished up the North Island of New Zealand — Te Ika a MŪi (the Fish of MŪi) — from the ocean floor. The South Island is his canoe (Te Waka a MŪi). The North Island's shape is explained by the struggles of the fish on the hook and the cuts made by MŪi's brothers fighting over the fish before MŪi could properly secure it.

**SNARING THE SUN:** The sun was traveling so fast across the sky that the days were too short for people to complete their work. MŪi and his brothers wove ropes and traveled to the sun's rising point — the cave where the sun slept each night — and ambushed it, lashing it with the ropes and beating it until it agreed to travel more slowly. This is why we have days long enough to live in.

**STEALING FIRE FROM MAHUIKA:** MŪi tricked his grandmother Mahuika (the goddess of fire) out of all her flames, then extinguished them all in water. When Mahuika threw her last remaining fingernails of fire in rage, they caught in specific trees — the mōhoe, the tōtara, the pate, the kaikōmako. These trees became the source of fire through friction (rubbing two sticks together). Fire lives in the wood.

**THE DEATH OF MŪI — AND HUMAN MORTALITY:** MŪi attempted to win immortality for humanity by entering the body of Hine-nui-te-pō (the goddess of death) while she slept — if he could pass through her body and emerge from her mouth, death would be reversed. His companions were cautioned not to laugh. As he began to enter, a fantail (pōwakawaka) laughed — the bird's laughter woke Hine-nui-te-pō, and she crushed him with her obsidian teeth. Death remained in the world. MŪi's failure to win immortality is thus the origin of human mortality — but also the origin of one of the most beloved and most morally complex sacred narratives in any tradition: the youngest, cleverest, most powerful demigod in the world failed at the one task that mattered most, and paid with his life.

## TE REO MŌRĪ

# The Sacred Language — Suppression, Revival, and Living Practice

Te reo MŌrĭ (the MŌrĭ language — literally 'the MŌrĭ voice') is one of the most theologically significant, most politically charged, and most recently reclaimed sacred languages on earth. It is not merely a communication system — it is the specific container in which the MŌrĭ sacred world exists, the medium through which whakapapa is transmitted, and the living proof that a people can choose their own cultural survival.

### TE REO MŌRĪ — THE SACRED CHARACTER OF THE LANGUAGE

**THE LANGUAGE AS WHAKAPAPA CARRIER:** Every significant noun in te reo carries whakapapa. The name of a mountain in MŌrĭ is not a label — it is an acknowledgment of the mountain's identity, its genealogical connection to the creation, and the human community's specific relationship with it. 'Ko Tongariro te maunga' (Tongariro is the mountain) is simultaneously a geographical statement, a genealogical claim, and a sacred acknowledgment. The English name 'Mount Tongariro' carries none of this. **SPECIFIC WORDS THAT DO NOT TRANSLATE:** Some te reo concepts cannot be translated without catastrophic loss: Whakapapa is usually translated as 'genealogy' but it is simultaneously the entire cosmological framework that connects all existence through sacred descent. Mana is usually translated as 'prestige' or 'authority' but it is the sacred force that flows through right relationship and right action. Tapu is usually translated as 'sacred' or 'taboo' but it is the specific protected status of things that carry the divine. Each of these concepts requires pages to explain in English that te reo expresses in a single word. **THE PROVERB AS SACRED TECHNOLOGY:** MŌrĭ oral tradition uses whakataukŭ (proverbs) as one of the primary technologies of sacred knowledge transmission — compact, memorable, paradoxical statements that carry complex sacred understanding. 'He aha te mea nui o te ao? He tangata, he tangata, he tangata' ('What is the greatest thing in the world? It is people, it is people, it is people') is simultaneously a social philosophy, a theological statement, and a guide to decision-making. The threefold repetition is not emphasis — it is the specific sacred structure of declaration in MŌrĭ oratory.

### THE SUPPRESSION AND THE REVIVAL — COMPLETE

THE SUPPRESSION: British colonial education policy systematically suppressed te reo Māori from the mid-19th century onward — children were punished for speaking Māori in schools, its use was discouraged in professional contexts, and the dominant educational and political culture treated the language as a relic that would (and should) disappear with modernization. By the 1970s, linguists estimated that less than 5% of Māori children were learning te reo as their first language. The language was formally classified as endangered.

THE TURNAROUND BEGINS: 1972: A Māori Language Petition delivered to Parliament with 30,000 signatures demanding te reo be taught in schools. 1975: Te Māori exhibition — the first major exhibition of Māori taonga (treasures) internationally — produced a cultural awakening about the depth and sophistication of Māori art and culture. 1982: Kōhanga Reo (language nests) established — the most significant single intervention. Te reo-only preschools where children are immersed in the language from infancy. From 6 nests in 1982 to over 800 today. 1985: Kura Kaupapa Māori — Māori-immersion primary schools established. 1987: Te reo Māori recognized as an official language of New Zealand. 1991: Wānanga (Māori universities) established. 2004: Māori Television launched — the first Māori-language television channel. 2016: Te Mātātini (the national kapa haka competition) draws 50,000+ attendees. 2022: A new generation of young Māori who speak te reo as a chosen language — not merely inherited but actively reclaimed — is the most significant development in the revival.

THE SACRED DIMENSION OF REVIVAL: The language revival is not merely a cultural project. In the Māori understanding, te reo is itself a taonga (treasure) — a sacred inheritance protected by the Treaty of Waitangi. When a speaker loses te reo, they lose access to the specific sacred world the language was built to hold. The revival is a restoration of the complete sacred world, not just the vocabulary.

## WHAKAPAPA

### The Living Genealogy as Sacred Technology

Whakapapa is the most foundational concept in the entire Māori sacred framework — the specific technology through which all existence is organized, understood, and maintained in right relationship. It is usually translated as 'genealogy' but that translation misses most of what whakapapa actually is.

#### WHAKAPAPA — COMPLETE UNDERSTANDING

**WHAT WHAKAPAPA ACTUALLY IS:** Whakapapa is the naming of layers — 'whaka' (to cause, to make, to render) + 'papa' (foundation, layers, the earth). Whakapapa is the specific practice of naming the layers of connection between any two things — the genealogical chain that connects them, the relational pathway through which right relationship is established and maintained. It applies not only to human genealogy but to the genealogy of all things: the whakapapa of the kumara (connecting it through Rongo to the creation), the whakapapa of a specific river (connecting it through the atua to Papatūānuku to the primal waters of existence), the whakapapa of a karakia (sacred prayer) connecting it to the first words spoken by the divine beings. **THE PEPEHA:** The formal self-introduction in Māori tradition — the most immediate practical expression of whakapapa. Every Māori person knows their pepeha: Ko [mountain] tōku maunga. Ko [river] tōku awa. Ko [waka] tōku waka. Ko [iwi] tōku iwi. Ko [hapū] tōku hapū. Ko [marae] tōku marae. Ko [tūpuna] tōku tūpuna. Ko [name] tōku ingoa. 'My mountain is [X]. My river is [Y]. My ancestral canoe is [Z]. My tribe is [A]. My subtribe is [B]. My marae is [C]. My ancestor is [D]. My name is [E].' The individual's name is the last item. Everything that gives the individual their place in the sacred order comes first. **WHAKAPAPA AS POLITICAL TECHNOLOGY:** In contemporary New Zealand law, whakapapa is the specific evidence used to establish Māori land rights, fishing rights, and resource rights. The ability to recite the complete whakapapa connecting your iwi to a specific piece of land, river, or coastal area — naming every generation in the chain back to the original ancestor who held relationship with that place — is legally admissible evidence in the Waitangi Tribunal and in New Zealand courts. Sacred genealogy as legal standing. Theology as jurisprudence.

## MANA and TAPU

### Sacred Force and Sacred Restriction

#### MANA — THE SACRED FORCE

Mana is the sacred power or authority that flows through right relationship, right action, and the maintenance of the specific obligations that whakapapa places on each person. It is not merely prestige or reputation — though both are expressions of it. Mana is the specific quality of a person, a community, a place, or an object that makes them effective, that gives their words weight, that makes their decisions binding. MANA CAN BE INCREASED: Through acts of generosity (manaaki — to care for others, to raise their mana, is itself the most reliable path to increased mana), through correct performance of ceremonial obligations, through successful completion of difficult tasks, and through the maintenance of right relationship with the atua and with the community. MANA CAN BE LOST: Through violations of tapu, through acts of cowardice or dishonesty, through failure to maintain sacred obligations, and through being conquered — the winner in any conflict takes some of the loser's mana. This is not permanent: mana lost can be restored through specific ceremonies (in warfare contexts, the specific ceremony of makutu or the formal acknowledgment of defeat and restoration through ceremony). MANA WHENUA: The mana of the land — the specific sacred authority that comes from being tangata whenua (people of the land), from having whakapapa connection to a specific place. Mana whenua is not merely political — it is the specific sacred relationship between a people and their land that gives them the specific obligation and specific right to speak for that land in ceremony, in politics, and in law.

#### TAPU AND NGA — SACRED RESTRICTION AND RELEASE

**TAPU:** The state of being sacred, restricted, set apart. A person, place, object, or time that is tapu carries the direct presence or protection of the divine — and therefore cannot be approached, touched, or interacted with in an ordinary way without specific ceremony. The head is permanently tapu (the most sacred part of the body — never touch a Māori person's head without permission; never pass food over someone's head). The tohunga is tapu during ceremony. A marae's specific areas are tapu. A new waka (canoe) is tapu until it is ceremonially released for use. **NĀ:** The release of tapu — the state of being ordinary, free from restriction, safe for ordinary interaction. Ceremonial food (eating) is one of the primary mechanisms for removing tapu from people, spaces, and objects. This is why food and eating are so central to Māori ceremony — the hākari (feast) that closes the pūwhiri is not merely hospitality. It is a specific sacred technology for releasing the tapu that has been built up during the formal ceremony, making the space and the people ordinary again. **THE TAPU/NĀ CYCLE IN CEREMONY:** Every major Māori ceremony moves through a specific tapu/nā cycle — entering sacred space (increasing tapu), conducting the ceremony (maximum tapu), and eating together (releasing tapu, establishing nā). The cycle is complete only when the nā is established. This is why you should never leave a formal Māori ceremony before the food — you are leaving before the tapu has been released.

# THE HAKA

## Complete Sacred Treatment — Five Types — Step-by-Step — Ka Mate in Full

The haka is the most internationally recognized element of Māori culture — and the most consistently misunderstood. It is not a war dance. It is not a performance. It is a sacred ceremony that uses the combined force of words, sound, breath, and movement to concentrate and project collective mana. The All Blacks perform one version of one type of haka before rugby matches. The tradition contains five distinct types with completely different sacred functions.

| THE FIVE TYPES OF HAKA — COMPLETE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>1. HAKA TAPARAHĪ (Standing haka — no weapons): The most widely used form. Performed for welcoming, for celebration, for expressing collective identity, and for marking significant occasions. Ka Mate is a haka taparahi. No weapons carried; the body itself is the instrument.</p> <p>2. PERUPERU (War haka with weapons and leaping): The most physically demanding and most historically charged form. Performed with weapons; includes specific leaping from the ground (demonstrating physical power and invoking Tū). Historically performed immediately before battle. The jumping was both a practical demonstration of fighting fitness and a sacred invocation of the atua of war.</p> <p>3. HAKA TANGI (Mourning haka): Performed at tangihanga (funerals) and in grief. The haka's concentrated power turns to the expression and honoring of collective grief. The physical intensity of the haka becomes the vehicle for emotion that cannot be expressed in ordinary speech.</p> <p>4. NGERI (Short, intense, spontaneous haka): No set choreography — pure emotional and sacred intensity. Performed for extreme emotion and specific atua invocation. The most personal and least scripted of the five types.</p> <p>5. HAKA PŪWHIRI (Welcome haka): Performed specifically as part of the pūwhiri welcome ceremony when visitors arrive at the marae. The welcome haka calls visitors forward and acknowledges their presence as significant.</p> |
| THE HAKA — COMPLETE STEP-BY-STEP SACRED PRACTICE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

**BEFORE THE HAKA BEGINS — THE INTERNAL PREPARATION:** The most important thing about the haka happens before a single word is spoken or a single movement made. The practitioner must reconnect to their whakapapa — the specific genealogical chain that gives them the right and the obligation to perform this specific haka. A haka is not generic. Every haka belongs to specific people. Ka Mate belongs to Ngāti Toa. The right to perform a haka comes from the whakapapa connection, not from learning the words.

**THE INNER STATE:** 'The haka is not performed. It is lived.' A technically perfect haka with no genuine inner state is an empty shell. A haka performed with full inner alignment — the whakapapa connection alive, the atua present, the mana fully concentrated — carries power even if the technique is imperfect. The inner state is the ceremony. The outer form is its vehicle.

**STEP 1 — THE OPENING CALL (WHAKAEKE):** The leader sounds the opening call — a single explosive word or phrase that crosses the boundary from ordinary into sacred. 'Ka mate!' or 'Hā!' or the specific opening of the particular haka. This is the threshold moment. Everything changes with the opening call.

**STEP 2 — THE NGĀKAU (FULL PRESENCE):** Every performer brings their complete self — no held-back energy, no self-consciousness, no awareness of being watched. The haka demands totality. Any part of the self held in reserve is a betrayal of the ceremony.

**STEP 3 — THE WORDS AS LIVING WHAKAPAPA:** The words of the haka are spoken/chanted with complete understanding of their meaning. Each line carries specific historical, genealogical, and sacred content. The performer does not merely recite — they inhabit the specific reality the words are creating.

**STEP 4 — THE BODY AS SACRED INSTRUMENT: THE STOMP (WAEWAE):** The feet stamp the ground — mana being driven into Papatūnuku, establishing the practitioner's connection to the earth, the ancestors who are within it, and the sacred ground of all being. Each stamp is a declaration: I am here. This is my land. My ancestors are in this earth.

**THE CHEST BEAT (POKO):** Hands striking the chest drive the mana outward from the center of the body — the concentrated force of the practitioner's inner sacred state projected into the space.

**THE PĀKANA (EYE WIDENING):** The eyes widen beyond ordinary range, the face contorts with concentrated sacred intensity. The pākana is not aggression — it is the concentrated inner state made visible in the most immediate way possible: through the face that the other person is looking at.

**THE WHĀTERO (TONGUE PROTRUSION):** The tongue extended fully. This is a declaration of vitality, of living sacred force. It is the tongue — the specific organ of sacred speech — displayed in its full power. Observers sometimes experience this as threatening; in the Māori understanding it is a declaration of aliveness.

**STEP 5 — COLLECTIVE SYNCHRONIZATION:** In a group haka, perfect synchronization is not merely aesthetic — it is the specific technology through which multiple individuals' mana is merged into a single unified sacred force. The mathematical relationship is not additive but exponential: the synchronized group generates more combined mana than the sum of the individuals performing separately.

**STEP 6 — THE CLOSING:** The haka closes with a specific word or phrase that formally concludes the ceremony and releases the concentrated energy. The practitioners return to ordinary consciousness. The sacred space that was created is formally dissolved.

## KA MATE — COMPLETE TEXT, HISTORY, AND SACRED MEANING

KA MATE was composed by the Ngāi Toa chief Te Rauparaha (c. 1768-1849) — one of the most powerful and most complex figures in early Māori history. The circumstance: Te Rauparaha was being hunted by enemies who wished to kill him. He concealed himself in a kāmara pit, covered by a chief's wife (a specifically tapu act — the woman's nāa canceling his tapu and making him invisible to pursuers who were reading sacred signs). When he emerged and found himself alive, he composed Ka Mate. THE COMPLETE TEXT WITH TRANSLATION: Ka mate! Ka mate! (It is death! It is death!) Ka ora! Ka ora! (It is life! It is life!) Ka mate! Ka mate! (It is death! It is death!) Ka ora! Ka ora! (It is life! It is life!) Tānei te tangata pūhuru (This is the hairy man) Nāna nei i tiki mai whakawhiti te rā! (Who fetched the sun and caused it to shine again!) ■, upane! Ka upane! (Up the ladder, up the ladder!) ■, upane! Ka upane! (Up the ladder, up the ladder!) Whiti te rā! Hā! (The sun shines! Rise!) THE SACRED MEANING: Ka Mate is not a war chant — it is a survival chant. The death/life alternation (Ka mate/Ka ora) is not metaphorical — it describes the specific moments when Te Rauparaha's death was certain alternating with the specific moments when survival was impossible but occurred. 'The hairy man' is the chief who hid him. 'Fetching the sun' is the emergence from the pit into daylight. 'Up the ladder' is the climbing out of the kāmara pit. 'The sun shines' is the moment of confirmed survival. Ka Mate is a prayer of gratitude for survival against all odds — performed with the full intensity of a person who has genuinely faced death and found themselves alive on the other side.

## THE WHARENUI

### The Meeting House as Sacred Ancestor and Living Cosmos

The wharenui (literally 'big house' — the meeting house at the center of every marae) is one of the most theologically sophisticated sacred architectural concepts in any tradition. It is not a building that represents an ancestor. It IS an ancestor — the specific ancestor of the iwi or hapū it belongs to, made material in wood and carving and present in the community as a living sacred being.

#### THE WHARENUI AS ANCESTOR — EVERY ELEMENT EXPLAINED

**THE TĀHUHU (RIDGEPOLE):** The spine of the ancestor. The ridgepole runs the full length of the building at the highest point — it is the backbone of the ancestor's body. The carvings on the tāhuhu connect the ancestor's genealogy across the full length of the building. **THE HEKE (RAFTERS):** The ribs of the ancestor. The rafters descend from the ridgepole to the side walls — they are the ribs of the ancestor's body, holding the structure together, defining the space of the interior. **THE MAIHI (BARGE BOARDS):** The arms of the ancestor. The two decorative boards that descend from the apex of the front gable are the ancestor's arms reaching outward and downward — welcoming, protecting, embracing. **THE KORURU (CARVED HEAD AT THE APEX):** The head of the ancestor — the carved face at the very top of the front gable. The most sacred element of the exterior. The pūkana (widened eyes) of the koruru face outward, watching the marae space continuously. **THE RAPARAPA (FINGERS AT THE END OF THE BARGE BOARDS):** The fingers of the ancestor's outstretched arms — the carved tips of the maihi. **THE INTERIOR:** To enter the wharenui is to enter the ancestor's body — to be sheltered within their embrace. The carvings on the interior walls (tukutuku panels and carved panels) contain the genealogical history of the iwi — every carving is a specific ancestor, a specific story, a specific chapter in the whakapapa that the wharenui embodies. Sleeping in the wharenui during a hui (gathering) is sleeping within the ancestor's body, surrounded by the presence of all the generations.

## THE MARAE and THE PŪWHIRI

### Sacred Ground and the Welcome Ceremony — Complete Step-by-Step

The marae is the sacred ceremonial complex — consisting of the marae ■tea (the open ground in front of the whareniui), the whareniui itself, the whare kai (dining hall), and associated structures. It is the specific place where the community's most important sacred work happens: the welcoming of visitors, the mourning of the dead, the celebration of significant occasions, and the maintenance of the community's relationship with their ancestors and atua.

#### THE PŪWHIRI — STEPS 1-3: APPROACH AND CALL

The pūwhiri transforms visitors (manuhiri) from outsiders into welcomed guests through a specific sequence of sacred actions. It is simultaneously diplomatic protocol, sacred ceremony, and tapu management technology. BEFORE THE CEREMONY: Manuhiri assemble outside the marae boundary and wait. Entering uninvited violates tapu. The waiting is the specific sacred position of the outsider before they have been made safe. STEP 1 — THE KARANGA (THE SACRED CALL): A senior kuia of the tangata whenua (host people) calls from within the marae to the waiting visitors. The karanga crosses between worlds — acknowledging the living visitors AND the ancestors who accompany them. A senior woman of the manuhiri responds from outside. The two women's voices together open the sacred space between groups. STEP 2 — THE PROCESSION (WHAKAEKE): Manuhiri process onto the marae ■tea led by their women, men following. Crossing the marae boundary is a sacred threshold crossing — from ordinary world into tapu sacred space. STEP 3 — THE WAIATA: As manuhiri take their position facing the whareniui, specific sacred songs are sung — appropriate to the occasion.

#### THE PŪWHIRI — STEPS 4-7: SPEECHES, HONGI, FEAST, CLOSING

STEP 4 — THE WHAIKĀRERO (FORMAL SPEECHES): Kaumātua from the tangata whenua deliver formal speeches in te reo Māori — opening karakia, whakapapa connection, acknowledgment of visiting group and their ancestors. A kaumātua from the manuhiri responds. Speeches alternate — typically three rounds. Protocol note: traditionally only men deliver whaikārero on the open marae ātea; women speak through karanga and waiata. This is contested within contemporary Māori communities. STEP 5 — THE HONGI (THE SHARING OF BREATH): The ceremony moves from formal/public to personal/sacred. Tangata whenua form a line; manuhiri approach one by one. The hongī — pressing forehead to forehead and nose to nose — is the sharing of the hā (breath, life force). In the creation narrative, Tāne breathed life into Hineahuone through her nostrils. The hongī is the recreation of that act between two living people. After the hongī, the visitors are no longer outsiders — they are part of the marae family for the duration of their stay. STEP 6 — THE HĀKARI (THE FEAST): Shared eating is the primary Māori technology for releasing tapu. The tapu accumulated during formal ceremony dissolves through communal eating. The manuhiri become nāa (free from restriction). The feast is not optional — leaving before it means leaving before tapu has been released. STEP 7 — THE CLOSING KARAKIA: A final prayer acknowledges the atua, thanks the ancestors who were present, and formally returns the space to ordinary conditions.

## THE TANGIHANGA

### The Māori Funeral — Complete Step-by-Step

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The tangihanga (from 'tangi' — to weep, to mourn, and 'hanga' — to construct, to make) is the Māori funeral ceremony — one of the most important, most sustained, and most communally intensive ceremonies in the entire Māori tradition. A tangihanga is not a single event; it is a multi-day ceremony through which the entire community collectively accompanies the tūpāpaku (the deceased's body) from death to burial.

#### THE TANGIHANGA — COMPLETE STEP-BY-STEP

IMMEDIATELY AFTER DEATH: The tūpāpaku is not left alone. From the moment of death, someone remains with the body at all times until burial. This is not merely respectful — it is a specific sacred obligation. The recently dead person's wairua (spirit) is understood as still present and still in transition. The community's presence is the specific sacred support the wairua needs during its transition. THE RETURN TO THE MARAE: The tūpāpaku is brought to the marae — specifically to the wharehau — where they will lie in state for the duration of the tangihanga (typically two to three days, though this varies). Lying in the wharehau means lying within the body of the ancestor that the wharehau embodies — a specific sacred location for the transition from living to ancestral. DAY ONE AND ONGOING — THE VISITORS: From across the country (and now from across the world), people come to pay their respects. Each group of visitors conducts a mini-pūwhiri as they arrive — the karanga, the procession, the whaikōrero acknowledging the deceased and the bereaved family. The family receives hundreds of groups across the days of the tangihanga, responding to each group's formal speeches with their own acknowledgments. The tangihanga is an exhausting marathon of ceremonial obligation — but each group's arrival is also a demonstration of the deceased's mana and the family's whakapapa connections. THE CONTINUOUS PRESENCE: Throughout the days of the tangihanga, people sit with the tūpāpaku — talking, singing waiata, telling stories about the deceased, weeping, laughing. The atmosphere is not solemn and restrained as at a Western funeral — it is alive with all the emotions that the person's life generated. The haka tangi (mourning haka) may be performed — the intense physical force of the haka becoming the vehicle for grief that is too large for ordinary expression. THE NIGHT: The tangihanga does not stop at night. People continue to arrive, continue to sit with the tūpāpaku, continue to sing and talk. The overnight sitting is one of the most demanding aspects of tangihanga for families — but also one of the most sacred. The darkness of Te Pō is the specific sacred time when the wairua is most actively present and most in need of human company. THE BURIAL: The tūpāpaku is carried from the wharehau to the burial site — usually on the marae or at the family's urupa (burial ground). The procession is accompanied by specific waiata, specific karakia, and the continuous presence of the community. Before the grave is closed, family members may speak final words directly to the deceased. The burial is the moment when the wairua fully departs — the tangihanga has held the space for that transition for several days. AFTER BURIAL — THE HĀKARI: The tangihanga closes with a feast — again, the specific sacred technology for releasing the tapu that has accumulated across several days of intense ceremonial life. The community eats together; the space is returned to nā. The person is now an ancestor.

## THE TOHUNGA

### Sacred Specialist — Types and Practice

#### THE TOHUNGA — COMPLETE PORTRAIT

The tohunga (from 'tohu' — sign, mark, skill + the suffix '-nga') is the Māori sacred specialist — a person who has received specific training and specific transmission in a specific sacred domain and who serves the community as the practitioner of that domain's knowledge and ceremony. The tohunga is not a generic 'priest' — there are many distinct types of tohunga, each with their own specific training, their own specific domain, and their own specific tapu.

**TOHUNGA WHAKAIRO (CARVING SPECIALIST):** The master carver who creates the sacred carvings on wharenui, waka, and sacred objects. The carver's work is itself a sacred act — the carving does not represent the ancestors, it activates their presence in the carved form.

Tohunga whakairo undergo years of apprenticeship and carry significant tapu during their carving work. **TOHUNGA TĀ MOKO (SACRED TATTOOING):** The specialist in tā moko — the sacred facial and body tattoos that carry the individual's whakapapa, their mana, and their genealogical identity. Tā moko is not decorative in the Western sense — it is a permanent sacred text written on the skin, recording the person's specific identity in the tradition's visual language.

**TOHUNGA WHAIORA (HEALING):** The sacred healer — using specific knowledge of medicinal plants (rongoā Māori), specific prayers and karakia, and specific ceremonial interventions to address illness. Māori healing understands illness as having both physical and spiritual dimensions — tohunga whaiora addresses both simultaneously.

**TOHUNGA AHU WHENUA (LAND EXPERT):** The specialist in land matters — the specific whakapapa of land, its history, the specific obligations that connect people and land. In contemporary New Zealand, tohunga ahu whenua provide expert testimony in Treaty of Waitangi claims.

**TOHUNGA WHĀNANGA (SACRED KNOWLEDGE KEEPER):** The keeper of the most restricted sacred knowledge — the specific ceremonial prayers, the most protected elements of the kete tuauri (the basket of ritual knowledge that Tāne brought from the highest heaven). This is the most restricted tohunga role.

## T■ MOKO

### Sacred Tattooing as Living Whakapapa

#### T■ MOKO — COMPLETE TREATMENT

T■ moko is the M■ori practice of sacred facial and body tattooing — one of the most artistically sophisticated and most theologically dense tattooing traditions in the world. Unlike decorative tattooing, t■ moko is not applied to the skin — it is cut into the skin using chisels (uhi) that create grooves and ridges rather than flat lines, making the tattoo three-dimensional. The specific patterns of t■ moko encode the individual's whakapapa, their mana, their iwi affiliation, and their specific sacred identity. THE SUPPRESSION: T■ moko was suppressed during the colonial period — Christian missionaries condemned it, colonial administration discouraged it, and by the early 20th century it had largely disappeared. The tohunga t■ moko tradition nearly died. THE REVIVAL: From the 1980s onward, t■ moko has been actively revived. Contemporary M■ori — particularly young M■ori — are choosing to receive t■ moko as an act of cultural reclamation and sacred identity assertion. The revival of t■ moko is one of the most visible expressions of the M■ori cultural renaissance. TE KANAWA (WOMEN'S T■ MOKO): Women's traditional moko was concentrated on the lips and chin (moko kauae) — a sacred marking that identified the woman's whakapapa and her specific sacred identity. Moko kauae has been particularly powerfully revived in contemporary M■ori culture, with M■ori women in professional, political, and artistic contexts wearing their moko kauae publicly as a declaration of identity and sovereignty.

Part Thirty-Seven and Thirty-Eight

## THE TREATY OF WAITANGI (1840)

### The Two Versions and the Contested Translation

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The Treaty of Waitangi — signed on February 6, 1840, at Waitangi in the Bay of Islands — is the founding document of New Zealand as a bicultural nation. It is also the most contested document in New Zealand history, and the contestation is not about interpretation of nuance — it is about two fundamentally different documents that were never properly reconciled.

**THE TREATY — THE COMPLETE HONEST TREATMENT**

THE TWO DOCUMENTS: The Treaty was drafted in English and then translated into te reo Māori. The vast majority of Māori chiefs signed the te reo version — not the English version. The two versions say materially different things on the most critical question. THE CRITICAL TRANSLATION: The English version grants the British Crown 'sovereignty' over New Zealand. The te reo version uses 'kōwhiri' — a transliteration of 'governorship,' not a translation of 'sovereignty.' The te reo version simultaneously guarantees to Māori chiefs 'tino rangatiratanga' — which translates most accurately as 'full chieftainship,' 'absolute authority,' or 'sovereignty' over their lands, villages, and all their treasures. In the te reo version, the Crown received governorship; the Māori retained sovereignty. The English version reverses this. THE SACRED DIMENSION: For the Māori chiefs who signed, the Treaty was a covenant — a specific sacred agreement between peoples, carrying the weight of whakapapa. A covenant, in the Māori understanding, creates an enduring obligation that cannot be unilaterally revoked. The specific promise of tino rangatiratanga was not a political concession to be later reinterpreted — it was a sacred covenant obligation. THE VIOLATIONS: The subsequent history of New Zealand involved the systematic violation of the te reo version's promises — land was taken through mechanisms the Māori did not consent to, the language was suppressed, tino rangatiratanga was denied, and the specific protections the chiefs understood they had been promised were repeatedly breached. THE CONTEMPORARY STATUS: The Treaty of Waitangi is today legally recognized as a founding document of New Zealand — not merely a historical relic. The Waitangi Tribunal (established 1975) has produced hundreds of reports on specific Crown violations of Treaty principles. Significant land and resource settlements have been negotiated. The 'Treaty principles' (partnership, participation, and active protection) are referenced in New Zealand law. Waitangi Day (February 6) is the national day — observed both as a celebration and as an ongoing site of reckoning with what the Treaty promised and what the Crown delivered. THE HALIGRIC SIGNIFICANCE: The Treaty of Waitangi is the most documented case in the world of an indigenous sacred covenant being made in two languages with two meanings, and then being interpreted — for 150 years — through the language of the colonizer rather than the language of the majority of signatories. It is the Haligric library's most immediate legal and political expression of the pattern that runs through the treatment of indigenous sacred traditions globally: the language of power defines what was agreed, regardless of what was actually said.

## The Whanganui River as Legal Person

### The Haligricity Lens: Ko Au Te Awa

In March 2017, the New Zealand Parliament passed the Te Awa Tupua (Whanganui River Claims Settlement) Act — making the Whanganui River a legal person with rights, duties, and liabilities of its own. It was the first river in the world to be granted legal personhood.

#### TE AWA TUPUA — THE COMPLETE SIGNIFICANCE

THE WHANGANUI IWI'S POSITION: 'Ko au te awa, ko te awa ko au' — 'I am the river, the river is me.' For the Whanganui iwi, this is not poetic metaphor or spiritual sentiment. It is a precise ontological statement: the river and the people are not two things in relationship. They are one thing that has two aspects — a human aspect and a river aspect. This is whakapapa applied to the natural world: the river and the people descend from the same sacred ancestors, are made of the same sacred substance, carry the same mana. THE LEGAL MECHANISM: The act gives the river two guardians — one appointed by the Crown and one by the Whanganui iwi — who speak for the river as they would speak for an ancestor. The river can now bring legal cases in New Zealand courts. It can be harmed (and the harm is legally actionable). It has standing. TE AWA TUPUA: The specific legal name given to the Whanganui River as a legal person — 'the river as ancestor.' Not 'the river that is like an ancestor' or 'the river that is sacred to the Whanganui iwi.' The river AS ancestor. The distinction is theological, not poetic. THE GLOBAL IMPLICATIONS: Since the Whanganui recognition, rivers in India, Colombia, Bangladesh, and Ecuador have been granted legal personhood or natural rights in various legal frameworks. The Māori concept of the river as ancestor has become a global legal movement.

*Ko au te awa. Ko te awa ko au. The Whanganui iwi said this for 700 years before Parliament agreed. Ranginui still weeps — his tears are the rain. Papatūnuku still sighs — her breath is the mist. Tāne's kauri forests still stand where they have not been cut. The fantail still carries messages through the forest. The haka still concentrates 700 years of ancestral mana into three minutes of ceremony. Te reo Māori was declared dying in 1980 — a generation chose it back. Ka Mate was composed by a man hiding in a pit, certain he was about to die, surprised to find himself alive. The Treaty promised tino rangatiratanga in the language the chiefs actually signed. The river is a person. The mist is an ancestor. I am the river. Grand Rising.*

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*"Ko au te awa.  
Ko te awa ko au.  
I am the river.  
The river is me.  
We were never two things.  
The law finally agreed."*

— Whanganui iwi saying, encoded in New Zealand law in 2017

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The Whanganui River is a legal person. Te reo Māori is spoken by a generation who chose it back. The tangihanga still holds the community around the tūpāpaku for three days. The pūwhiri still transforms strangers into guests through the sharing of breath. The wharehau still shelters the living within the body of the ancestor. Te moko is written again on the faces of Māori women in Parliament, in boardrooms, in universities. The haka is still the most powerful ceremonial form available to a people who refused to disappear. Grand Rising.

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